FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-32-19001

Issue Title : Landing Gear Control Lever Faults Investigation

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3231-11	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
03/18/2019	12/05/2023	12/13/2022

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date

Revision Description

Status and Interim Action section update.

Applicability

Landing Gear Control Lever Module (LGCLM) PN: D724-03-001 applies to all 737 MAX Airplanes (-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ).

Description

Multiple instances of Proximity Switch Electronics Unit (PSEU) Related Flight Deck Effects (FDEs), which relate to Gear Lever Faults are being recorded by Boeing's diagnostic and prognostic tool called Airplane Health Monitoring (AHM).

This Fleet Team Digest (FTD) article is written to raise fleet awareness of this fault category reported via Boeing Communication System (BCS), to provide interim actions when faced with reports of Gear Lever related faults, and to obtain additional units for examination.

Background

Most 737MAX airplanes are delivered and put into service with Boeing's AHM diagnostic and prognostic tool. The AHM records the Status Messages during engine start and are displayed via the Present Leg Fault (PLF) after landing.

Since Entry Into Service (EIS), AHM has recorded multiple instances of Proximity Switch Electronics Unit (PSEU) Related Flight Deck Effects (FDEs) related to Gear Lever Faults. As a result, Boeing received several reports of GEAR LEVER and GEAR LEVER

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SW STATUS Messages. The noted STATUS messages were associated with Maintenance Messages (MM 32-62613 [PSEU ALL GEAR LEVER UP AND DOWN SIGNALS DO NOT AGREE] and MM 32-62623 [PSEU GEAR LEVER UP AND DOWN SIGNALS DO NOT AGREE].

One operator reported that after airplane power-up, a GEAR LEVER SW STATUS message accompanied with MM 32-62623 (PSEU GEAR LEVER UP AND DOWN SIGNALS DO NOT AGREE) was displayed under PSEU Fault History. PSEU circuit breakers were cycled to fix the issue.

Another Gear Lever fault event (reported after landing) involved a MAINT light illuminating during flight. Flight crew found correlated FDE STATUS message GEAR LEVER with MM 32-62613 (PSEU ALL GEAR LEVER UP AND DOWN SIGNALS DO NOT AGREE). To troubleshoot, PSEU LRU Replacement Test was performed, but failed. Subsequently, ground personnel cycled the landing gear lever and forward thrust lever and the PSEU LRU Replacement Test passed.

Additionally, a report of Gear Lever failure was involved in a TOO LOW, GEAR Alert. LGCLM was replaced and the issue was rectified. Review of flight data also confirmed that LGCLM switch did not perform as expected. Unit was sent to supplier for evaluation.

To rectify the issue, Operators in some cases would remove the LGCLM and send to BAE Systems for investigation.

In March 2018, Service Related Project (737MAX-SRP-52-0137) was approved authorizing Boeing and BAE Systems to investigate the Gear Lever Faults along with (6) other 737MAX PSEU Related FDEs causing Service Delays/Interruptions (SD/I) and the (2) non-SD/I causing FDEs per 737MAX-FTD-32-18001 (737MAX PSEU Related Service Interruptions/Delays).

Status

Boeing reviewed the Airplane Data Recorder (ADR:ALL) data and confirmed that the Landing Gear Lever Sys 2 UP signal was stuck in the UP position when the gear lever was moved from the UP to DOWN position on approach until shortly after landing.

BAE Systems examined (5) In-Service LGCLM units and captured the following results:

1. LGCLM is NFF to date and has additional tests/analysis planned.

2. Switch was replaced precautionarily; Fault unconfirmed; Unit scrapped at Collins Aerospace; NFF

3. Unit passed incoming test including extended power on solenoid; Fault unconfirmed; Unit shipped back to operator

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4. An intermittent switch performance at contact was initially found, which were not connected to airplane systems; LGCLM has completed 100X landing Gear lever cycles with no failures captured.

5. LGCLM has completed 150X landing gear lever cycles with no failures captured.

The findings indicate the problem is isolated to the microswitches and not the PSEU. As a result, the following risk mitigation steps was captured by BAE Systems to isolate potentially discrepant microswitches and solenoids prior to delivery to Boeing:

1. Collins Aerospace added Micro-Switch Build Check to verify Micro-Switch Assembly alignment and free movement of the attached Micro-Switch levers

2. BAE Systems added 10X Landing Gear Lever cycles and verifies Micro-Switch continuity after each Landing Gear Lever movement

3. Collins Aerospace added 20X Landing Gear Lever cycles and verifies Micro-Switch continuity after each Landing Gear Lever movement

4. Collins Aerospace implemented instructions to move handle slowly during test

5. Collins Aerospace and BAE Systems both added solenoid performance screening test with reduced pull-in voltage condition; voltage application reduced from 28VDC pull-in (as required by the Specification Control Document (SCD)) to 19VDC pull-in

Various tests have been enhanced and/or added to mitigate failures at several stages during the manufacturing process. These include the following:

1. Collins added a bench test process on the individual switches to verify resistance and continuity as received from supplier using a milli-ohmmeter
2. Collins added a micro-switch assembly build check to verify switch assemble alignment
3. Collins began recording the solenoid pull-in voltage
4. Collins added a step to their continuity check where the lever is cycled 20x verifying continuity throughout. This test happens twice, once in Bangalore, India and another in Lippstadt, Germany
5. BAE changed their DITMCO test to verify all switch contacts for both the up and down states over 10x actuations
6. BAE changed their DITMCO test to check the solenoid at 19V rather than 28V

There have been no factory rejections reported by BAE. Collins is continuing to monitor their production and have not observed any production issues on newly developed switches since production improvements were implemented. Based on this, there are no further improvements that have been identified other than what has been implemented in Supplier production as noted.

This FTD will be closed and be on a watch list to monitor field performance for any potential unit failures and disposition. Any failed units experienced in the field shall be sent back to Supplier for failure evaluation / analysis and to capture data points to support any future production improvements initiatives (as determined required).

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Interim Action

To clear the faults, Operators are advised to perform the following:

1) With gear lockpins installed, perform the PSEU LRU Replacement Test per AMM 32-09-10-710-801

2) If faults continue, reset the PSEU circuit breakers: PSEU PRI and PSEU ALTN

3) If faults continue, replace the LGCLM

4) Send the removed LGCLM to the Supplier for investigation. See Supplier Information section or details.

5) Download and send ADR:ALL data per AMM 46-13-02-970-802. Provide the ADR:ALL data to Boeing via message courier to VM-FRDS with copies sent to: paul.w.bandy@boeing.com, mark.m.tinawi@boeing.com; and bradley.f.nye@boeing.com.

NOTE: The download and sending of ADR:ALL data is an OPTIONAL step and is only required upon request from Boeing (as determined required) to support failure evaluation. Please do not send the ADR:QAR data as this is not the correct data to review and analyze for PSEU related faults.

Final Action

The Final Action is the production improvements implemented. No further action is required.

Milestones

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Note: Milestones and Target dates are estimated and based upon currently available status and have risk for future revision.

Investigation Findings: Complete

Root Cause Established: Complete

Solution Selected: Complete

Operator Action

See Interim Action.

Part Information

See Parts List

Supplier Information

For matters related to the P2-1 Center Forward Panel (Panel Module Assembly):

BAE Systems
Fort Wayne Service Center
2000 Taylor St. Dock 1
Fort Wayne, Indiana 46802-4605 USA
E-mail: baefwaservctr@baesystems.com
Phone: 260-434-5600
Fax: 260-434-5616
BAE Systems Website: http://www.baesystems-ps.com/customersupport/

For matters related to the Landing Gear Control Lever Module:

Goodrich Lighting Systems, GmbHA
Collins Aerospace (formerly UTC Aerospace Systems Company (UTAS))
Bertramstrasse 8, D - 59557
Lippstadt, Germany
Phone: +49 (2941) 7676-0
Attention: Dirk Christensen and Joerg Schroeder

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Fleet Team Digest Article (FTD)	737MAX-FTD-32-18001		01/22/2019

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Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
P2-1 Center Forward Panel		BAE Systems	233A2226-6
Landing Gear Control Lever Module		Collins Aerospace (formerly UTAS)	D724-03-001

Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability
- AOGs : Events that cause a significant Airplane On Ground (AOG) condition
- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability
- Dispatch Reliability Issues : Issues that cause revenue flight delays and cancellations
- Flight Deck Effects and Maintenance Messages : Issue that occurs frequently and causes a flight deck effect or maintenance message

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